

## THE BOILER MAN

In November the boiler broke. A heating engineer called Gary came round on a Saturday morning, and in the ninety minutes he spent in your airing cupboard you told him about padel, the club, the fastest-growing sport in the world and the fact that "a man with your forearms would be brilliant at it". Gary is fifty-eight and has a bad shoulder. He left without charging for the second visit, and has since moved your address to another engineer's list.

### NO. 18 · CHECKLIST

## People you will not invite this month

Tick each person as you complete a full month without inviting them to padel.

- ☐ Your dad
- ☐ Graham
- ☐ Priya
- ☐ The Hendersons next door
- ☐ Any tradesperson who is working in your house
- ☐ The new graduate, now the new graduate's replacement
- ☐ Any parent at swimming, ballet, nursery or a children's party
- ☐ Anyone in a hospital, a hospital car park or a hospital gown